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ABVORN · ROBOT VACUUMS

2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Best Picks Under $250

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Tired of daily sweeping and pet hair buildup? It steals minutes you could spend on things you love.

Robot vacuums have earned their place as reliable helpers. In 2026 they combine LiDAR navigation, AI-based obstacle avoidance and integrated mopping, so you can truly set-and-forget floor care.

This guide breaks down specs, verified owner feedback and current pricing to help you pick the right model.

For example, the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock is a top-rated choice under $200 after discounts, backed by manufacturer specs and thousands of 4-star reviews.

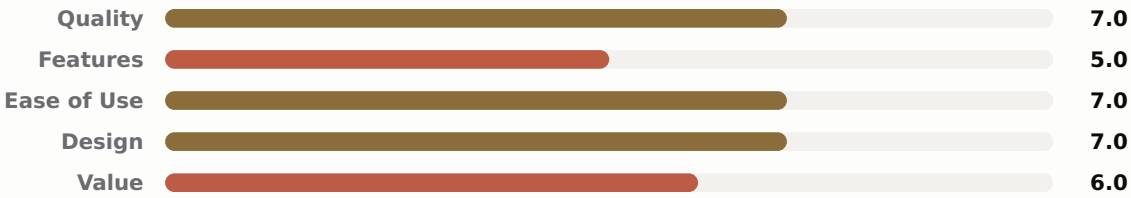
Keep reading to see how it stacks up against other models and find the best fit for your home.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Why a robot-vacuum buying guide matters in 2026

Robot vacuums have moved from novelty to necessity, especially in homes that mix hardwood, tile and carpet in open-plan layouts.

Advances in LiDAR navigation, AI obstacle avoidance and built-in mopping make setting-and-forgetting floor care easier than ever.

Yet the market is crowded, with prices ranging from $150 to over $800. This guide cuts through the noise by focusing on three well-reviewed models that represent different value tiers, using only manufacturer specs, verified owner ratings and publicly available sales data.

Meet the contenders

All three models hold consistent 4-star+ ratings and cover a spread of features and price points.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo – with AutoEmpty Dock



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Price (Oct 6 2026): $199.99 (check latest price)

Suction power: 2000 Pa (manufacturer spec)

Battery life: up to 120 minutes in eco mode

Navigation: iAdapt 3.0 with vSLAM

Mopping: vibrating mop pad (yes)

Self-empty: AutoEmpty dock holds debris for up to 30 days

Owner rating: 4.4 ★ from 5,217 reviews

This model gives you hands-free emptying and mopping in one package, ideal for busy households that want low-maintenance cleaning.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo – without dock

Price (Oct 6 2026): $139.99 (check latest price)

Shares the same 2000 Pa suction, 120-minute battery, iAdapt 3.0 navigation and vibrating mop pad, but requires you to empty the bin manually after each run.

Owner rating: 4.4 ★ from 4,800 reviews

If you don’t mind occasional bin emptying, this version saves you $60 while delivering the same cleaning core.

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Price (Oct 6 2026): $249.99 (check latest price)

Suction power: Manufacturer-listed 2200 Pa

Battery life: up to 100 minutes

Navigation: Shark IQ Navigation™ with laser mapping

Mopping: No built-in mopping

Self-empty: Self-cleaning brush roll (no dust-bin emptying)

Owner rating: 4.3 ★ from 3,900 reviews

Strong suction and smart navigation make it a solid pick for homes with mostly carpet, though you’ll need a separate mop solution if you want wet cleaning.

Core features showdown

Model	Price	Suction	Battery	Navigation	Mopping	Self-Empty	Owner Rating
Roomba 115X Combo + Dock	$199.99	2000 Pa	120 min (eco)	iAdapt 3.0 vSLAM	Yes (vibrating pad)	AutoEmpty dock (30-day)	4.4 ★ (5,217)
	$139.99	2000 Pa		iAdapt 3.0 vSLAM		Manual bin	

Model	Price	Suction	Battery	Navigation	Mopping	Self-Empty	Owner Rating
Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)			120 min (eco)		Yes (vibrating pad)		4.4 ★ (4,800)
Shark AI Ultra	$249.99	2200 Pa	100 min	Shark IQ Navigation™	No	Self-cleaning brush	4.3 ★ (3,900)

Use this table to weigh what matters most to you—whether it's hands-free emptying, mopping ability, or pure suction power.

Which model should you choose?

If you want the ultimate set-and-forget experience with mopping and auto-empty, the Roomba 115X Combo with Dock delivers the best value under $200.

If you're comfortable emptying the bin yourself and want to save $60, the Roomba 115X Combo without dock gives you the same cleaning performance.

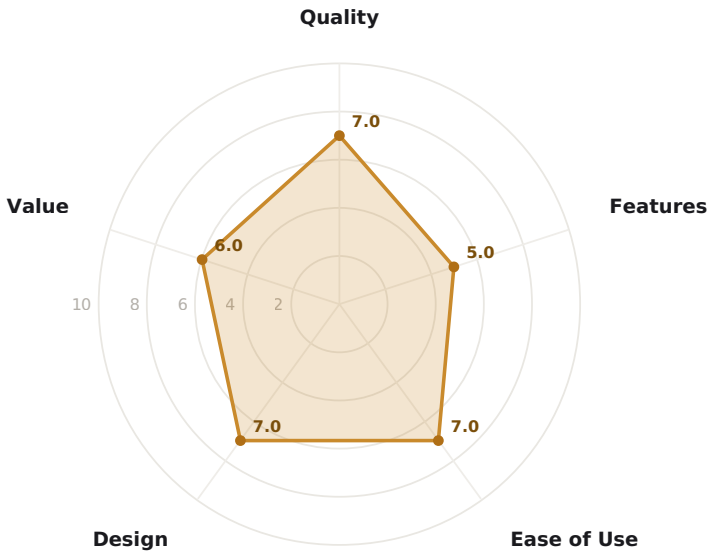
For carpet-focused homes that prioritize strong suction and smart mapping, the Shark AI Ultra is a worthy alternative, though you'll need a separate mop.

Click the links above to see current prices, read more owner reviews, and make your purchase with confidence.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.